Home-making involves various types of activities which are most of the time tedious, monotonous, time consuming and involves various types of skill. Most of the work if done without much skill and under pressure would lead to unhappiness or frustration. To manage the house one should know the best way of doing each household activity. To do the work easily one should know why, how, when, who and where a work should be done.

Dr. Marvin Mundel (1985) has given five factors (classes of change) that influence the character of work. They are:

1. Change in hand and body motions

Work can be simplified by using each part of the body properly and economically.

This can be achieved by,

1. Keeping body parts in alignment
2. Using muscles effectively
3. Doing the work in rhythmic motion
4. Developing skill in work.

2. Change in equipment and work arrangement

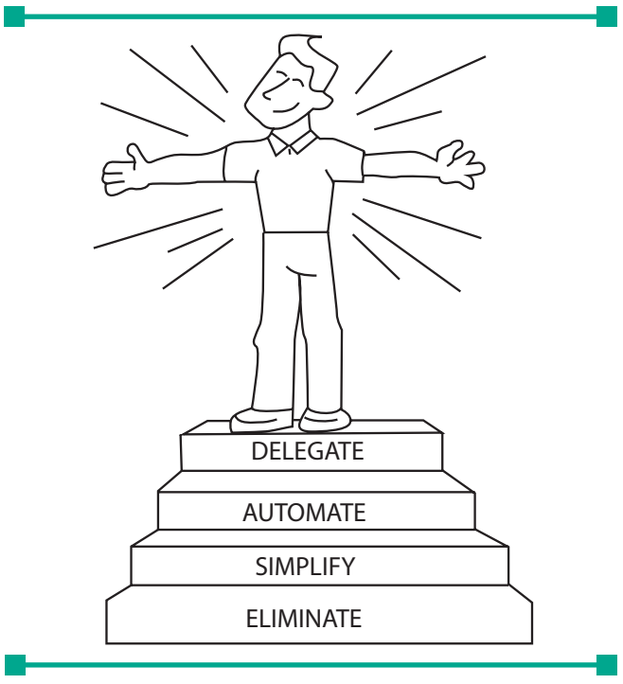
Using labor saving devices, planning work surfaces at proper height, depth and width with proper tools and adequate storage space and lighting will improve the efficiency of work.

3. Change in production sequence

When there are lot of household activities to be accomplished, time and energy can be saved by simplifying the work through combining the tasks and eliminating unnecessary steps.

4. Change in finished product

Simplification of work could be achieved by changing the standards or expectations of the finished product. Instead of laying a dining table in a formal way, especially when the mother is working outside home, she can just keep food items on the table and members in the family can help themselves.



5. Change in material

This refers to the change in the raw ingredient to get the same final products. For example, instant Vada mix or Dosa mix can be used to prepare the same final product, at the same time requirement for pre-preparation of Vada or Dosa from raw materials can be reduced.

7.7 Money Management

Among all the resources that are available to the family, the most important one is money. Money plays an important role in the life of man as an instrument through which he can satisfy his physical, material and mental needs. The income and expenditure pattern of the family decides the family's standard of living and its place in the society.

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